



INSTALLATION GUIDE

CortexPLM

Install, start and sign in, step by step

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1. Before You Start

This guide installs CortexPLM on one computer so you can use it in a web browser. You do not need programming skills. Every command is given exactly as you type it. The whole installation takes about 15 minutes.

1.1 What you need

Item	Requirement
Computer	Windows 10 or 11, macOS 12 or newer, or Linux
Free disk space	About 1 GB
Memory	4 GB or more
Web browser	Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge or Mozilla Firefox (recent version)
Internet	Needed once, during installation, to download components
Node.js	Version 22.13 or newer (the LTS version from nodejs.org). Section 2 shows how to install it.
Application file	CortexPLM_Application.zip

1.2 What is in the zip file

Folder	What it is
server	The application engine and its database. It runs in a first window.
web	The screens you use in the browser. It runs in a second window.
README.md	A one-page summary of the commands.

Good to know You will keep **two black command windows** open while you use CortexPLM: one for **server** and one for **web**. Closing a window stops that part.

2. Install Node.js

Node.js is the free engine that runs CortexPLM. Install it once.

1. Open your browser and go to **<https://nodejs.org>**.
2. Download the version marked **LTS** (22 or newer).
3. Open the downloaded file and follow the installer. Keep the default choices and select **Next** until **Finish**.
4. Check the installation. Open a command window (see Section 3.2), type **node -v** and press **Enter**. You should see a version such as **v22.13.0** or higher (for example **v24.11.0**).

Tip If the command window says that "node" is not recognized, close all command windows, open a new one and try again. If it still fails, restart the computer.

3. Unzip the Application

3.1 Extract the files

1. Create a folder for the application, for example **Documents\CortexPLM**.
2. Copy **CortexPLM_Application.zip** into that folder.
3. Windows: right-click the file and select **Extract All**, then **Extract**. macOS: double-click the file.
4. Open the extracted folder. You should see the folders **server** and **web**.

3.2 Open a command window in a folder

System	How to open a command window inside a folder
Windows	Open the folder in File Explorer. Click the address bar at the top, type cmd and press Enter .
macOS	Open Terminal (Applications > Utilities > Terminal). Type cd followed by a space, drag the folder onto the Terminal window and press Enter .
Linux	Right-click inside the folder and select Open in Terminal .

4. Start the Server (first window)

Open a command window in the **server** folder, then type these three commands, one at a time. Press **Enter** after each and wait until it finishes.

Step	Type this	What happens	How long
1	npm install	Downloads the components the server needs.	1 to 3 minutes
2	npm run seed	Creates the database with seven demonstration organizations (one per sector), 147 projects and their history. It ends with "Done".	About 1 minute
3	npm run dev	Starts the server. It shows "CortexPLM API is running on http://localhost:4000".	A few seconds

Important Leave this window open. The server stops when the window closes.

Warning **npm run seed** erases the database and recreates the demonstration data. Run it only the first time, or when you want to start again from a clean demonstration.

5. Start the Web Application (second window)

Open a second command window, this time in the **web** folder, and type:

Step	Type this	What happens	How long
1	npm install	Downloads the components of the screens.	1 to 3 minutes
2	npm run dev	Starts the web application. It shows "Local: http://localhost:5173/".	A few seconds

6. Open CortexPLM and Sign In

1. Open your browser and go to **http://localhost:5173**.
2. Type an e-mail address and a password from the tables below, then select **Sign in**.
3. The dashboard of the organization opens.

6.1 Platform administrator

E-mail	Password	Can do
admin@cortexplm.example	Admin#2026	Everything, in every organization. Switch organization from the top bar.

6.2 Demonstration organizations

Every organization has the same set of users. Build the e-mail address from a user name and the organization domain, for example **pm1@metrocity.example**. The password is always **Demo#2026**.

Group (Yes / No)	Group	Organization	Sector	Domain
No	—	Metro City Digital Services Agency	Public Sector	metrocity.example
Yes	Atlas Infrastructure Holding	Cedarline Precast Systems	Manufacturing	cedarline.example
No	—	Meridale Health Network	Healthcare	meridale.example
Yes	Crescent Agro-Energy Group	Valdora Dairy Cooperative	Agro-Business – Dairy Products	valdora.example
Yes	Atlas Infrastructure Holding	Orvane Transit Group	Transportation	orvane.example
Yes	Crescent Agro-Energy Group	Kestrel Energy & Utilities	Oil, Gas & Energy	kestrel.example
Yes	Atlas Infrastructure Holding	Ridgeway Real Estate Development	Real Estate Development	ridgeway.example

Each organization has 21 projects (for example **PUB-001** to **PUB-021**), at least ten instances of every end-to-end process, a team tree (OBS) with roles for every project, sample attachments, checklist templates and AI use cases. Open **Portfolio > Groups, organizations & projects** to see the whole tree Group (Yes / No) > Organization > Projects. Organizations of the same group can compare their indicators in **Portfolio > Benchmarking** and see each other's projects read-only in **Portfolio > Portfolio overview**.

6.4 Create your own group and organization

1. Sign in as **admin@cortexplm.example** and open **Portfolio > Groups, organizations & projects**.
2. Optional: select **Add group**, type a name and **Save** (Group: Yes). Skip this for an independent organization (Group: No).
3. Select **Add organization**: answer **Belongs to a group?**, type the name, choose the sector, country and subscription.
4. Keep **Create the starting team** ticked, type the e-mail domain (for example **acme.example**) and an initial password of at least 8 characters, then **Save**.

5. The organization receives its standard content and one account per role, such as **pm1@acme.example**. Sign in with that account to create the first project. The User Guide walks through six complete examples.

6.3 User names and roles

User name	Role in the application
exec	Executive Sponsor (records gate decisions)
board1	Gate Review Board member
pm1	Product Manager (runs projects)
pm2	Product Manager (French or Arabic interface in two organizations)
portfolio	Portfolio Manager
engineering	Engineering Lead
quality	Quality Manager
compliance	Regulatory & Compliance Officer
finance	Finance Controller
marketing	Marketing & Sales Manager
process	Process Owner / Track Administrator
admin	Organization administrator
auditor	Internal Auditor (read-only)
supplier	Supplier (external portal)
customer	Customer (external portal)

Note The licence of Orvane Transit Group expires in 22 days. A yellow banner shows this on purpose, to demonstrate the licence warning.

7. Stop and Start Again

7.1 Stop the application

In each command window, press **Ctrl + C** (on macOS as well). If asked "Terminate batch job?", type **Y** and press **Enter**. Then close the windows.

7.2 Start the application the next time

You do not need to install again. Your data is kept.

Window	Folder	Type this
First	server	npm run dev
Second	web	npm run dev

Then open **http://localhost:5173** in your browser.

7.3 Reset the demonstration data

Stop the server window (**Ctrl + C**), type **npm run seed**, then **npm run dev** again. All changes are lost and the demonstration data is recreated.

7.4 Back up and restore

While the server runs, it writes one copy of the database per day to **server/data/backups** and keeps 14 days of copies.

To	Do this
Make a backup now	In a command window in the server folder, type npm run backup . Or sign in as the platform administrator and select Back up now in Administration > Configuration .
Restore a backup	Stop the server (Ctrl + C). Copy the chosen file from server/data/backups over server/data/cortexplm.db . Start the server again with npm run dev .
Keep backups elsewhere	Copy the server/data/backups folder to another disk or a network share regularly.

8. Optional Settings

The application works without any setting. The items below are for administrators who want to go further.

Setting	How to change it
Port numbers	In the server folder, copy .env.example to a new file named .env and change PORT . The web application expects port 4000.
Security secret	In .env , replace APP_SECRET with a long random text before real use.
Outgoing e-mail	In .env , fill in the SMTP_ lines with your mail server. Without them, e-mail notifications stay queued and in-app notifications still work.
Live AI model	Optional. In the application, open Settings or Administration > Configuration & AI model , card Live AI model . Choose the provider, choose a model in the list (Claude Opus 5 by default) or Custom model... to type another name, paste an API key and select Test connection , then Save connection . The key stays in the browser. Without a key, the built-in suggestions are used.
Attachments	Files attached to tasks are stored in server/data/uploads (up to 25 MB each). Include this folder in your backups.
Backups	In .env , BACKUP_RETENTION_DAYS sets how many days of backups are kept (default 14); BACKUP_DAILY=off stops the automatic daily backup.
OnPrem licence file	In .env , set DEPLOYMENT_MODE=onprem . The vendor signs a licence with npm run sign-licence ; the administrator installs it in Administration > Licensing .

9. Troubleshooting

What you see	What to do
"node" or "npm" is not recognized	Node.js is not installed or the window was opened before the installation. Close the window, open a new one, and check with node -v .
"CortexPLM needs Node.js 22.13 or newer"	Install the current LTS version from nodejs.org, then run npm install again.
npm install shows network errors	Check the Internet connection. On a company network, ask IT whether a proxy is required for npm.
"The database is empty"	Stop the server (Ctrl + C), type npm run seed , then npm run dev .
"Port 4000 is already in use"	CortexPLM is already running in another window. Use that window, or close it and start again.
The browser says the site cannot be reached	The web window is closed. Start it again with npm run dev in the web folder.
The sign-in page says "Request failed" or nothing happens	The server window is closed or still starting. Start it and wait for "CortexPLM API is running".
"E-mail or password is incorrect."	Check the address (for example pm1@metrocity.example) and the password Demo#2026 . Passwords are case-sensitive.